

ELSEWHERE..

HEAR, HEAR: Indira Gandhi went to the electorate with a new socialist agenda



● Israel launched its first ever overland assault on Lebanon. Jordan cracked down on Palestinians, driving them into Lebanon (below).

AFP

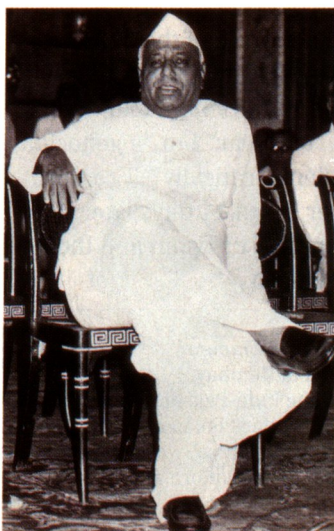


● Tension between China and the Soviet Union mounted, with each accusing the other of preparing for war.
● Japan launched its first satellite, Ohsumi-1, becoming the fourth nation with a space rocket powerful enough to launch satellites into Earth's orbit, after the Soviet Union, the US and France.

"WE CAN'T REMAIN VICTIMS OF MARKET FORCES."

Y.B. Chavan

So said Yashwantrao Balwantrao Chavan during his term as Finance Minister. Through his blazing political career as the right hand man of Indira Gandhi, the Maratha icon who started out as the first chief minister of Maharashtra held several key Cabinet portfolios. His decisiveness as defence minister during the 1965 war didn't go unnoticed, and in 1970, with the reins of the Home Ministry in his hands, he was the one to introduce the bill for annulling the princes' privileges in Parliament.



PRAMOD PUSKARNA

TRUE LIES

The cloud of mystery surrounding Lal Bahadur Shastri's death darkened as the Government ruled out a judicial probe into the case. Shastri had died in January 1966, after signing a no-war agreement with Pakistan President Ayub Khan in Tashkent, Soviet Union. He was said to have died of a heart attack that night, but many still believe there was more to it.

36,000

miles was the distance travelled by Indira Gandhi between December 1970 and the elections that were held ten weeks later. She addressed almost 300 meetings and was seen or heard by an estimated 20 million people.